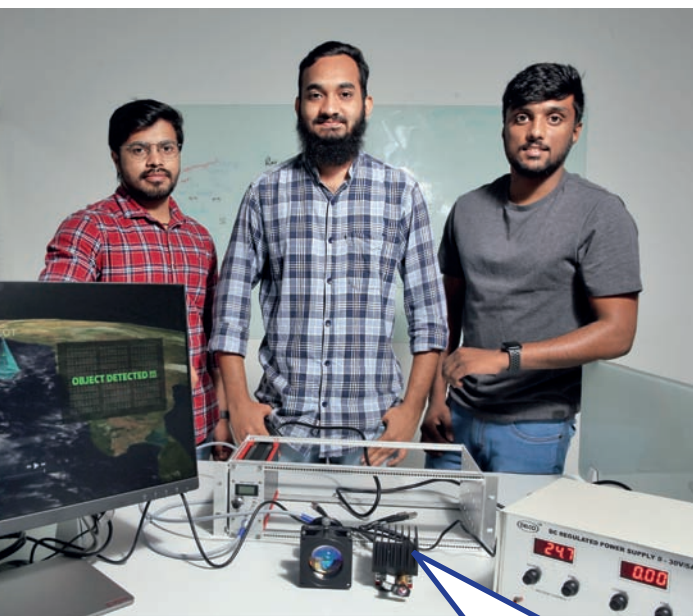


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DIGANTARA RESEARCH & TECHNOLOGIES, BENGALURU

Founded 2018

Founders (L to R) Rahul Rawat, Tanveer Ahmed, Anirudh N. Sharma

Employees 10

Product Surveillance platform utilising a constellation of nanosatellites to provide predictive and situational awareness services

Funding \$2.5 million from Kalaari Capital

one of the early players in the field. In a landmark development, we also became the first start-up to sign an MoU with ISRO in 2021, when it came forward to help us build our rockets by providing access to their test and launch facilities and other expertise,” says Chandana. They have already contracted some clients. “Our customers are satellite operators active in the areas of telecommunications, space broadband or earth observation, where we will be providing them with transportation services to their desired orbit,” says his partner Daka.

Ever since its inception, India’s space programme has been funded by the government. From the time it was founded in 1969, ISRO has developed a network of more than 400 vendors specialising in technology development, manufacturing and supply of components. Some of the prominent vendors include names like Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL), Larsen

PHOTO BY KRISHNENDU HALDER



SKYROOT AEROSPACE, HYDERABAD

Founded 2018

Founders (L to R) Naga Bharat Daka, Pawan Kumar Chandana

Employees 150

Product Small-lift, expendable Vikram series of launch vehicles designed to carry small satellites into Earth’s orbit

Funding The company has raised \$17 million in funding to date

& Toubro, Godrej & Boyce, Alpha Design Technologies and Centum Electronics. The push for start-ups in the space sector is part of the vision to expand private sector participation in high technology by enabling the growth of companies that are capable of developing end-to-end solutions.

Some of the most important developments happened in 2020 when the government announced the opening of the commercial space sector to non-government private entities (NGPEs), marking the change from a supply-based model to a demand-based model. This was soon followed by the creation of the Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPaCE), the single window nodal agency for authorising, promoting and regulating private players. Thereafter, draft policies on remote sensing and satellite communications were also released.

“The first point is that we want to make available